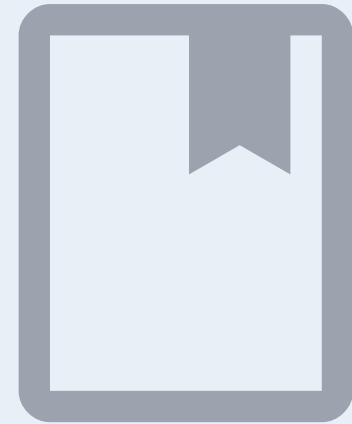


Important N2 Japanese Grammar Structures

Overview and Analysis of N2
Grammar Patterns

Presented by Sapiens AI Team



1. Grammar Pattern ～一方だ (Ippou da)

N2

Form

- Verb (dictionary form) + 一方だ

Characteristics

- Expresses one-sided change, no reverse direction.
- Often used for negative changes/trends.

General Meaning

- Increasingly, following a single direction.
- More and more; continue to ~.

Illustrative Examples

- 住民の不安は広がる一方だ。
- 携帯電話の加入者数は増加する一方だ。
- 日本の人口は減る一方です。

2. Grammar Pattern ～一方で (Ippou de)

Meaning: On one hand, on the other hand; meanwhile; while.

Used to connect two aspects, actions, or situations, indicating contrast or simultaneity.



Usage 1: Contrasting Situations

Highlights two opposing aspects of the same thing or situation.

留学生生活は楽しい一方で、大変なこともたくさんある。

Study abroad life is fun, but also difficult.



Usage 2: Concurrent Actions

Describes two actions or states happening in parallel.

私は通訳として働く一方で、オンラインで日本語も教えている。

Working as a translator while teaching Japanese online.

Distinction from ～一方だ

～一方で: expresses contrast or simultaneous actions.

～一方だ: indicates a continuous, one-directional change (e.g., getting worse/better).

● ～一方だ

不安は広がる一方だ。

Anxiety spreads more and more.

3. Grammar Pattern ～反面 / 半面 (Hanmen)

Meaning

On the other hand, while one aspect is true, an opposite or different aspect is also true.

キーワード : On the other hand

Characteristics

- ✔ Highlights opposing aspects of an issue/situation.
- ✔ Emphasizes a balanced perspective.

Structure

- ▶ V/いA (plain)+ 反面
- ▶ なA/N である/だった+ 反面

Examples

この車は、空気を汚さない反面、価格が高いという欠点がある。

This car doesn't pollute the air, but on the other hand, it has the drawback of being expensive.

現代の若者は、情報に接する機会が多い。その反面、体験が不足している。

Young people have many chances to access information, but they lack real-life experience.

この布は水に強い反面、熱には弱い。

This fabric is strong against water, but on the other hand, it's weak against heat.

Commonly used in formal or written Japanese.

4. Grammar Pattern 〜ばかりだ (Bakari da)

JLPT N2 Grammar

Structure: V(dictionary form) + ばかりだ

Meaning 1: Continually, increasingly

(Negative trend)

Indicates a situation continuously developing in a negative direction, implying things are getting worse over time.

Example:

- 頑張っているのに、業績は悪くなるばかりです。
- Despite working hard, performance is just getting worse.

Meaning 2: Only, just

(After completing other tasks)

Indicates that everything else has been done, and only one final action or state remains.

Examples:

- やれることは全部やった。あとは祈るばかりだ。
- I've done everything I can. All that's left is to pray.
- 全員揃いました！あとは小林さんが来るのを待つばかりです。
- Everyone's here! Now we just have to wait for Kobayashi.

5. Grammar Pattern ~上 (ni) (Ue ni)



Meaning:

Not only... but also (in addition to)

Characteristics:

- Adds further information
- Emphasizes degree

Formation:

- Verb-casual + 上(に)
- Noun + の + 上(に)
- いadj + 上(に)
- なadj + な + 上(に)

Example 1: Meeting Tardiness

"佐藤さんはほぼ毎日遅刻する上によく会議で居眠りする。(Sato-san not only is late almost every day, but also often dozes off in meetings.)"

Example 2: Island Bus Issues

"この島のバスは、路線が複雑な上、運賃も高いので、利用者は少ない。(The buses on this island are not only complex in route, but also expensive in fare, so there are few users.)"

6. Grammar Pattern 〜た上 (で)

N2

Meaning

After A... then B. A is a necessary condition that must be completed before B can occur.

Structure

Verb in ta-form + 上で

Verb in ta-form + 上 (more formal)

Key Notes

Subjects of A and B are usually the same.

Not used for actions that normally happen in sequence.

Examples

→ 医師と相談した上で、ワクチンを接種するかどうかご判断ください。

Decide on vaccination after consulting a doctor.

→ こちらが契約書です。内容をご確認の上、サインをお願いします。

Sign the contract after confirming contents.

→ 離婚は長く考えた上での決定だから、気持ちが変わることはない。

Divorce is a decision made after long consideration.

Grammar Pattern ～上 (で)

08

(Ue de) - During the Process

Meaning

- In the process of...
- In the case of...
- When performing V...

Application

Refers to necessary conditions within a process.

Examples

"外国語を勉強する上で、いい教科書は欠かせない。

A good textbook is essential for learning foreign languages.

"面接を受ける上で、気を付けるべきことは何でしょうか。

Things to be careful about during an interview.

8. Grammar Pattern ~上 (は) (Ue wa)

JLPT N2 Grammar



Meaning 1: Perspective / Basis

Indicates the basis, aspect, or perspective used to make observations and judgments.

● Examples

暦の上ではもう春ですが、寒い日がまだまだ続いています。

有休をとって他社の面接を受けるのは、法律の上では問題ない。

竜は想像上の生き物で、実際には存在しない。

Meaning 2: Inevitability / Obligation

When a situation has arisen, a natural or obligatory course of action must follow.

● Structure

Vる/た + 上は

● Examples

目標を決めた上は、それに向かって前向きに行動しなければならない。

事態がこうなった上は、もう彼一人に任せてはおけない。

9. Grammar Pattern ～（よ）うとする (You to suru)

Meaning

To intend to, to try to, to want to do something. Also, to be just about to do something.

Formation

Verb (volitional form) + とする

Nuance

Often implies an attempt that was interrupted or unsuccessful, or a strong intention.

Examples

1. 電話をかけようとしたとき、玄関のベルが鳴りました。
The doorbell rang just as I was about to make a call.
2. 自分の立場を説明しようとしたが、彼女はどうしてもそれを受け付けなかった。
I tried to explain my situation, but she wouldn't accept it.
3. 彼女がその外国人結婚しようとしているのを支持していた。
Supporting her desire to marry that foreigner.

10. Grammar Pattern ～思い (Omoi)

Meaning

Expressed as a noun, 'omoi' refers to **thoughts, feelings, hopes, desires, or sentiments**. It can describe a state of mind or an internal sensation.

Examples

“その知らせにはっと現実には引き戻される思いがした。”

Felt abruptly pulled back to reality by the news.

“喜びというより責任感の方が多くてその大きさに身が引き締まる思いです。”

The sense of responsibility is greater than the joy, making me feel tense.



Meaning & Nuances

Both patterns convey essentiality or consistency, but differ grammatically.



欠かさず (kakasazu): Adverbial. "Without fail," "diligently," "never misses."



欠かせない (kakasenai): Adjectival. "Indispensable," "essential," "vital."



Examples

異文化間の交流には、相手を理解しようという姿勢が欠かせない。

An attitude of understanding is indispensable in cross-cultural exchange.

私は大学生なのでコンピューターも日常生活に欠かせないものです。

A computer is essential for student life for a university student.

12. Grammar Pattern ～くらい / ～くらいだ (Kurai / Kuraida)

Meaning

Used to express the extent or degree of something, often implying an extreme level. It can also signify an approximate amount or level.

● Extent

● Approximation

Formation

- ▶ Verb-casual + くらい/ぐらい
- ▶ I-adjective + くらい/ぐらい
- ▶ Na-adjective + なくらい/ぐらい
- ▶ Noun + くらい/ぐらい
- ▶ Amount/Time/Date + くらい (for approximation)

Examples

怖くて怖くて、大声で叫びたいくらいだった。
(So scared I wanted to scream)

くやしくて泣きたいくらいだ。
(So frustrated I wanted to cry)

彼ぐらい日本語が上手なら、どんな仕事だってできるだろう。
(If one's Japanese is as good as his, they can do any job)

Meaning

Expresses that rather than doing a negative or undesirable action (A), a different option (B) is considered better or preferable, even if B is extreme.

Formation

Verb-dictionary form + くらいなら/ぐらいなら



Examples

1. そのパソコン、捨てるくらいなら私にください。

If you're going to throw away that computer, give it to me.

2. 途中で止めるくらいなら始めない方がいい。

If you're going to quit halfway, it's better not to start.

3. あの人に謝るくらいなら、むしろ死んだほうがましちやう。

Rather than reconcile with such a person, I'd rather die.

Summary & Practice

Review of Grammar Patterns

～一方だ
～一方で
～反面 / 半面
～ばかりだ (negative)
～ばかりだ (only)
～上 (に)
～た上 (で)
～上 (で) (during)
～上で (は) / ～上 (は)
～上は
～ (よ) うとする
～思い
欠かさず / 欠かせない
～くらい / ～くらいだ
～くらいなら

Practice Exercises



Sentence Completion (問題 1)

- 20 questions



Sentence Rearrangement (問題 2)

- 4 questions

Important Notes for Usage

Focus on context, nuance, and common pitfalls for correct grammar application.

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